

What to do next

Notice 1: INA § 274D — Fine for not leaving after a deportation (removal) order (P2026-00012345)

Your deadline

Your papers must be **mailed (postmarked) by Tuesday, October 20, 2026**. That is 15 business days from the date of the notice (weekends and federal holidays do not count). Do not wait until the last day.

- Deadlines are counted from the date printed on the notice, even if it reached you late. If you are not sure, send your papers right away.

Step by step

Step 1: Read your papers carefully

- Check that your name, A-Number, Penalty Tracking Number, dates, and amount are correct.
- Make sure everything is **true**. When you sign, you are promising under **penalty of perjury** (lying is a crime) that it is true.
- If something is wrong, go back in the app, fix it, and download your papers again.

Step 2: Print and sign

- Print every page, on one side of the paper. No printer? Try a public library, a print shop (like FedEx Office, Staples, or The UPS Store), or a community organization.
- Sign with blue or black ink: **the cover letter** (page 1, above your name) and **the written defense** (the “Signature” line on its last page). Write the date next to “Today’s date” and on the cover letter.
- The person who translated for you must sign and date the **Certificate of Translation** (the last page).

Step 3: Fill out the “Notice of Appeal” page of your notice

- Your notice has a page called **NOTICE OF APPEAL** (usually the last page, page 4 of 4).
- In the space under “I am filing an appeal of a Notice of Violation and Order for the following reasons,” write: **“I deny the violation. Please see my attached written defense and brief.”**
- Check the box **“I have attached a separate written brief or statement.”** If you are also sending copies of documents (see the next step), check **“I have attached additional documentary evidence.”**
- Sign and date it. Fill in: Printed Name **María González López**, File Number **012-345-678**, Penalty Tracking Number **P2026-00012345**, your mailing address, phone, and email.
- If you do not have this page anymore, still send your papers. Your cover letter says that you are appealing.

Step 4: Add copies of papers that support what you said (optional, but helpful)

- You can include a copy of **your notice** (all pages), your **Order of Supervision**, papers showing your **ICE check-ins**, your **ISAP** papers, **receipts or decisions** for your immigration applications, **letters from doctors** or medical records, and proof of your

income, like **pay stubs or a tax return**.

- **Send copies only — never originals.** Keep all your original papers.
- Do not send anything you are not comfortable with the government seeing. If you are unsure, ask a lawyer.

Step 5: Make a copy of everything for yourself

- Before you mail it, copy (or take clear phone photos of) **every page** you are sending, including the signed pages. Keep them in a safe place with your notice.

Step 6: Mail it at the post office

- Put everything in a large envelope. Write your address in the top-left corner.
- Mail it **to:** U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement, Attn: Civil Fines, 500 12th St. SW, Mail Stop 5202, Room 11078, Washington, DC 20536-5202.
- At the post office counter, ask for **Certified Mail with Return Receipt** (or **Priority Mail Express**). These give you proof of mailing and a tracking number. Use the U.S. Postal Service, not FedEx or UPS.
- Write the Certified Mail number on your copy of the cover letter. **Keep the receipt.**
- Mail it **by October 20, 2026.**

Step 7: Track it and keep your proof

- Track your envelope at https://tools.usps.com/go/TrackConfirmAction_input using your tracking number.
- When the green Return Receipt card comes back, keep it with your copies.

What happens next

- A supervisory officer (someone who did not make the first decision) will review your appeal. Your notice says they will usually decide within **45 days** after your appeal is filed.
- They may ask you for more information. If they do, you must answer within **15 days**. Open all mail from DHS right away.
- If they agree with you, you will get a paper saying the fine is **reversed, cancelled, or rescinded**. Keep it forever.
- If they do not agree, you will get an **Appeal Decision and Order**, and later a bill. There is no other appeal inside DHS, but you may be able to challenge it in **federal court**. Talk to a lawyer quickly if this happens.

If you get a bill (invoice) later

- **Do not ignore it.** Bills can come from U.S. Customs and Border Protection (CBP), the Department of the Treasury's Centralized Receivables Service (CRS), or a private debt collector.
- **Bill from CBP:** you can dispute it in writing by email to **INACivilPenalties@cbp.dhs.gov** within **10 calendar days** of the invoice date. Include your Penalty Tracking Number and send these same papers again.
- **Bill from CRS (Treasury):** use the free CRS Dispute Form and cover letter: <https://noimmigrationfines.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/09/6-CRS-Dispute-Form.pdf> and https://noimmigrationfines.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/09/7-CRS-Dispute-Cover-Letter_081925.docx
- **Letter from a private debt collector:** send them a dispute letter right away (sample:

<https://library.nclc.org/companion-material/sample-dispute-letter>). The law says they must pause collection when you dispute the debt.

- This app can also make dispute papers for a bill — start a new notice and choose “A bill (invoice) or past-due notice.”

Important to know

- **Should I just pay?** Talk to a lawyer first. DHS may treat payment as admitting that you did something wrong. If you do pay, write **“Payment under protest, with reservation of rights”** on your check or money order.
- **Is it risky to fight the fine?** It is up to DHS to prove the fine is justified. The lawyers at noimmigrationfines.org encourage people to file an opposition and raise their defenses.
- **If you move,** tell ICE (and the immigration court or USCIS, if you have a case there) your new address right away, so you do not miss important letters.
- **Lawsuit:** A class action, *Maria L. v. Noem* (D. Mass.), challenges INA § 274D and § 240B fines. Check noimmigrationfines.org for updates.

Get help

- Questions and answers about these fines: <https://noimmigrationfines.org/#FAQs>
- Find free or low-cost legal help: <https://www.immigrationadvocates.org/legaldirectory/>